

Cavalrymen did play a key role in battles, usually by dismounting and fighting on foot ahead of their line in the style of skirmishing infantry. On foot, Union cavalry with carbines were formidable opponents in a firefight.



Union cavalry skirmishing

This contemporary sketch shows troopers of the 1st Maine Cavalry Regiment. They are fighting dismounted in a skirmish line—the most common and often most effective way for cavalry to engage in Civil War battles.

“ There are only two arms that cavalry should use ... the repeating **magazine gun ... and the **revolver**.”**

UNION CAVALRY COMMANDER JAMES H. WILSON

Destructive raids